



North America

The third-largest continent is dominated by the United States and Canada—two of the world's largest countries. It is bordered on the east by the Atlantic Ocean, and by the Pacific Ocean on the west. At its northern tip, in the freezing waters of the Arctic Ocean, are the ice sheets of Greenland. In the southernmost part of the continent lie the seven countries of Central America and the Caribbean islands, where the climate is warm all year round.

▼ SONORAN DESERT

Stretching across the southwestern United States and northwestern Mexico is the hot, dry, and windy Sonoran Desert. It is the exclusive home of the saguaro cactus. Covered in spines, and white flowers in late spring, this huge, tree-sized cactus lives for about 200 years.

